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The Power of Paradoxes

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👋 Hello, Curious Minds!

Life is full of contradictions, isn't it? We want simplicity, yet we crave complexity. We seek freedom, yet we thrive within boundaries. As 2025 unfolds, I find myself reflecting on the paradoxes that define both work and life—and how they can inspire growth if we let them.

Here are a few paradoxes that stand out:

1. To Focus, We Must Let Go

In the pursuit of clarity, we often try to hold onto everything—every opportunity, every responsibility. Yet, true focus comes from letting go of what doesn't matter. It's in the act of saying "no" that we create space for our most important "yes."

Reflection: Where can you let go to create room for what truly matters?

2. To Lead, We Must Follow

Leadership isn't about always having the answers; it's about listening, learning, and adapting. Sometimes, the most effective leaders are those who are humble enough to follow and wise enough to empower others to lead.

Reflection: How often do you listen to learn, rather than to reply?

3. To Grow, We Must Embrace Discomfort

Growth doesn't happen in the comfort zone. It's in the moments of challenge, failure, and uncertainty that we stretch ourselves and discover new strengths. The paradox? The discomfort we avoid is often the gateway to the growth we desire.

Reflection: What uncomfortable step could lead to your next breakthrough?

4. To Innovate, We Must Preserve

Innovation often feels like a call to disrupt everything, yet the best ideas come when we preserve the essence of what works while imagining what could be better. It's a dance between continuity and change.

Reflection: What traditions or values do you honor, even as you innovate?

5. To Connect, We Must Disconnect

In a hyper-connected world, true connection sometimes requires stepping away—taking a moment to reflect, recharge, and be present. The paradox? Disconnecting helps us reconnect more meaningfully.

Reflection: When was the last time you truly disconnected to reconnect?

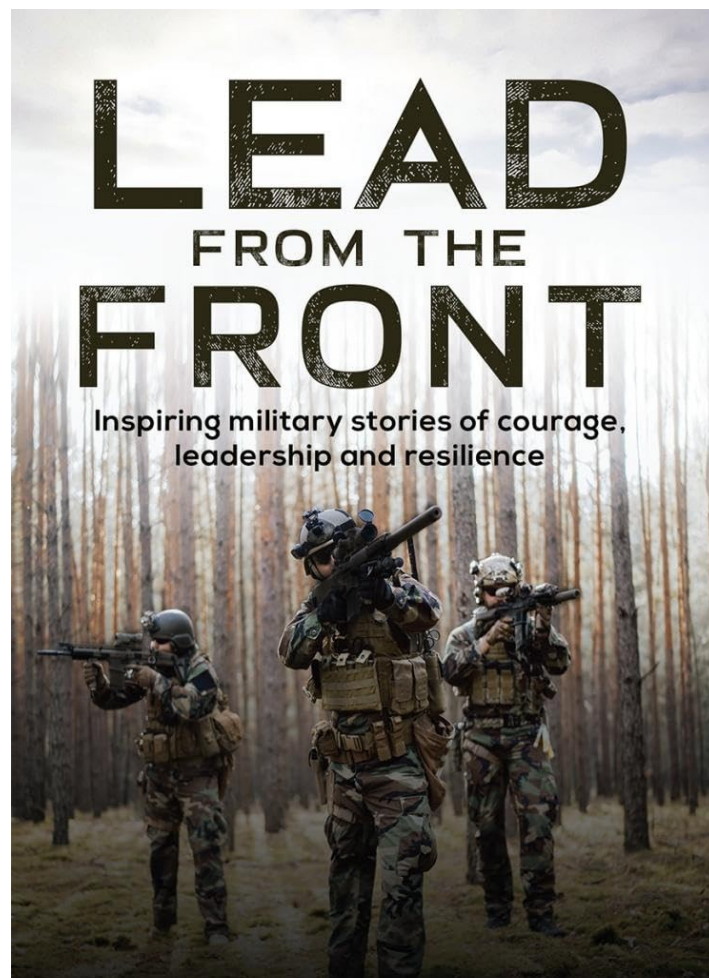
My Takeaway for 2025:

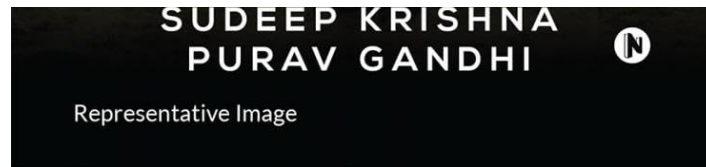
Paradoxes aren't big problems to be solved—they're tensions to be navigated. They remind us that life isn't black and white; it's a spectrum of nuance. Embracing these contradictions doesn't make us weaker; it makes us wiser.

As you step into this week, I invite you to reflect on your own paradoxes. Where do you find tension, and how might you lean into it to find strength?

Here's to navigating the beautiful complexity of life, Vikas Surani *signing off*

*P.S. Thank you to 2,100 subscribers! 🙏 As promised, this week's gift for Being Curious subscriber is the book **Lead from the Front** and it goes to **Vishal Majithia**, a first of my well-wisher, and genuinely a good fellow to have a chat with.*





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 **Saumendra Rathod** · 1st
Oracle Cloud Project/programme Management

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Paradoxes being powerful is just a confirmation bias only truth is what Cersei Lannister said "Power is power".

Insightful · 🏆 1 | Reply · 1 reply

 **Vikas Surani**  Author
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10mo ...

[Saumendra Rathod](#) nteresting take! In my view, power itself is neutral—what you make of it defines its impact. Even Cersei learned that the hard way. 😊

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 **Prasant Nayak** · 1st
Senior Bid Manager | Pursuit Management Specialist | Large Deal...

11mo ...

This is so true, Vikas and often I feel that life itself is so full of paradoxes - In fact, maybe that's what it's meant to be. The best way is how one navigates through such tough moments, choosing to ignore

the non-value adding and focusing on what really matters. If we go wrong along the way, there is always room and opportunity to improvise

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Vikas Surani



Author

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Prasant Nayak glad it resonates with you and you got insightful perspectives, do keep sharing

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